

SkillUP Customer Experience: Design Justification

Group Design C

1. Overview

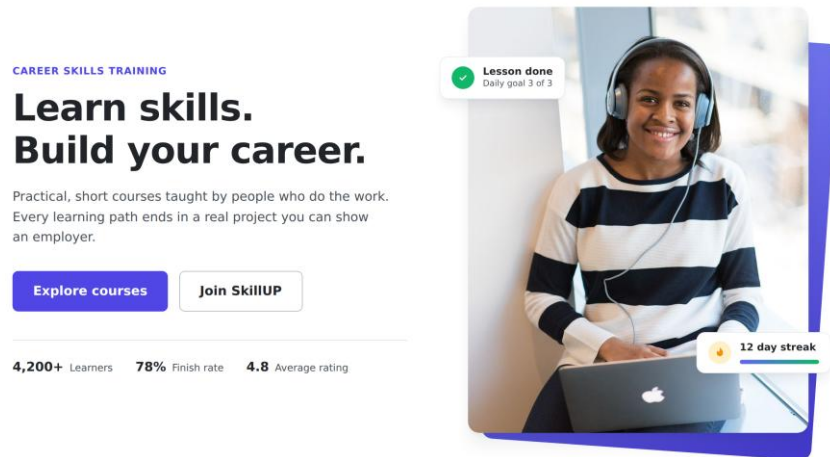


Figure 1: The SkillUP landing page

Design C covers the whole customer journey on SkillUP. A learner can log in and browse the catalogue. Courses go into a cart and are paid for at checkout. After that the learner works through the lessons while the site tracks their progress.

Our client felt that other learning sites look boring and wanted ours to pop. We answered this with the Peak-End Rule and with what we learned from testing three existing sites.

2. Design Requirements

The design needed to:

- Revise the login page and the products page.
- Let users add courses to a cart and check out.
- Track progress through each course.
- Give clear feedback whenever a button is pressed.
- Make checking out and finishing a course stand out.
- Keep the rest of the site calm and easy to use.

3. Research Influence

We ran short UEQ sessions on Coursera, Udemy and Khan Academy. Each site did part of the journey well and part of it badly. The table below shows what we took from each one.

Site	What we found	What we did
Coursera	Three pop-ups appeared before the first lesson.	Buying a course takes one step.
Coursera	The loading screen showed an encouraging fact.	The payment screen shows a short learning tip while it waits.
Coursera	A daily goal counted the lessons done that day.	Learners get a daily goal of three lessons.
Udemy	An upsell appeared the moment a course was added to the cart.	Our confirmation shows a tick and the course name only.
Udemy	The saving and the final price were easy to see.	The cart shows the saving in rands. The pay button shows the exact amount.
Udemy	Almost every course carried a large discount.	Only four courses are on sale. The offer feels real.
Khan Academy	Small ticks kept learners going. The big reward came at the end.	Lesson ticks stay small. Confetti is saved for the finish.
Khan Academy	The next lesson sat inside the celebration.	Every celebration has a clear next step.
Khan Academy	The course page opened on rows of empty squares.	An empty learning page shows a drawing of the first win.

4. The Peak-End Rule

The Peak-End Rule says people do not remember an experience as an average. They remember its strongest moment and the way it ended (Kahneman et al., 1993). A checkout with a great ending can feel better than a shorter one that ends flat.

We used this to decide where the effort should go. Feedback on SkillUP works like a ladder with three levels.

Level	Where it happens	What the user sees
Quiet	Adding to the cart and finishing a lesson	A tick and a short message
Middle	Signing up and reaching the daily goal	An animated tick with the next step
Peak	Paying and finishing a course	Confetti with the course photo and a number the learner earned

Only the two peaks use confetti. Nothing else on the site moves that much. This lets both moments stand out. Every flow also ends on a next step. The payment celebration links straight to the first lesson and the course celebration points to the next course. Learners never reach a dead end.

5. Key Moments

5.1 Pushing a button

Every button responds where it is pressed. A ripple spreads from the point of the click and the button dips slightly. Adding a course to the cart goes further. The button turns green and shows a tick for a moment. A short message names the course while the cart badge in the header bounces.

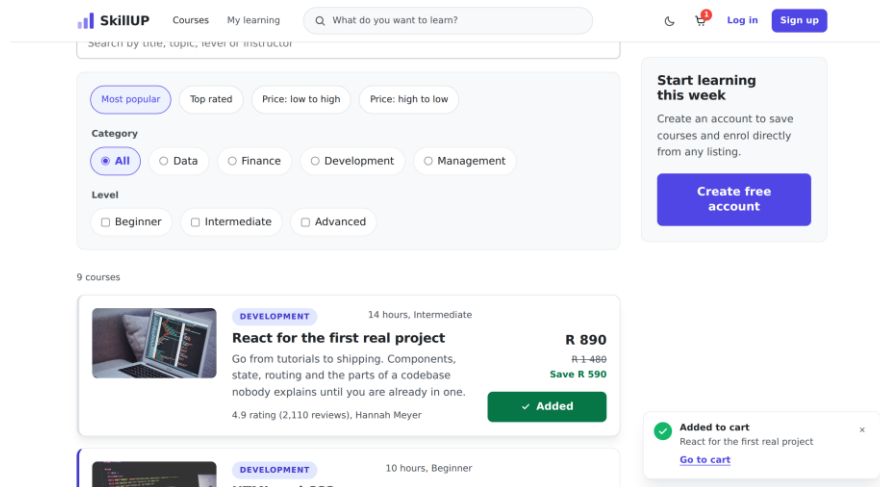


Figure 2: Adding a course to the cart

The message is kept small on purpose. Its only job is to say that the click worked.

5.2 Checking out

The cart lists each course with its photo. Courses on sale show the old price and the saving in rands. Near the button the cart says plainly that nothing is charged yet.

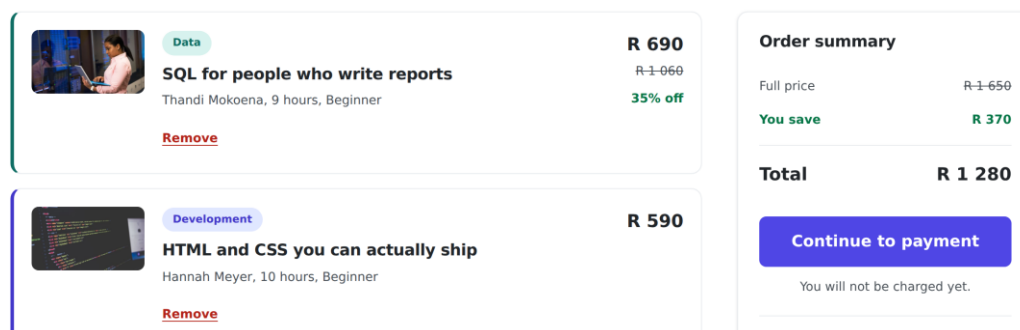


Figure 3: The cart

On the payment page the button carries the total. The refund promise sits right beside it. While the payment goes through the screen shows a learning tip instead of a bare spinner.

The payment page is divided into two main sections. On the left, there are form fields for card information: 'Name on card' (filled with 'Naledi Khumalo'), 'Card number' (filled with '4242 4242 4242 4242'), 'Expiry' (filled with '12/30'), and 'CVC' (filled with '123'). A small note below the card number states: 'Any 16 digits work here. A number ending in 0000 is declined on purpose.' Below these fields is a large blue button labeled 'Pay R 1 280'. On the right, the 'Order summary' section lists items: 'SQL for people who write reports' (R 690) and 'HTML and CSS you can actually ship' (R 590). It shows a 'Full price' of 'R 1 650', a 'You save' amount of 'R 370', and a 'Total' of 'R 1 280'. At the bottom of the summary, a green checkmark icon is next to the text: 'Full refund within 14 days, no questions asked.' Below the payment button, a small disclaimer reads: 'This is a prototype. No card is stored and no money moves.'

Figure 4: The payment step

Then the first peak arrives. Confetti falls and the photo of the course appears with a trophy. The first lesson is one click away on the same screen.

5.3 Tracking progress

The learning page shows today's goal next to the streak and the courses finished. Each course also has its own progress bar. Inside a course the sidebar ticks off each lesson when it is done. The top of the lesson shows its place in the course. Learners can see the finish line before they start.

The learning progress dashboard consists of three main cards at the top. The first card, 'Today's goal', shows '2 of 3' lessons finished today with a green progress bar and a '3 days in a row' streak. The second card, 'Streak', shows '3 days' and the instruction 'Come back tomorrow to keep it alive'. The third card, 'Courses finished', shows '0 of 3' and 'Certificates unlock at 100%'. Below these is a large banner for 'React for the first real project' with a laptop image, the text 'PICK UP WHERE YOU LEFT OFF', '5 of 24 lessons done', and a 'Continue' button.

Figure 5: The learning page

The lesson page is split into a sidebar and a main content area. The sidebar, titled 'My learning', shows the course 'React for the first real project' with a '2 / 3' goal and a '3 days in a row' streak. It indicates '5 of 24 lessons, 21%' completion. Under 'MODULE 1: Components, properly', it lists three completed lessons with green checkmarks: 'Props, composition and the component that does too much', 'Splitting by responsibility rather than by file size', and 'Building the first three screens of the project'. The current lesson, 'Styling approaches and picking one on purpose', is selected with a radio button. The main content area shows 'Lesson 4 of 24: Components, properly' with the title 'Styling approaches and picking one on purpose'. It features a video player placeholder showing a laptop screen with code. A note at the bottom states: 'The lesson player is a placeholder in this prototype.'

Figure 6: A lesson with the progress sidebar

5.4 Finishing a course

Marking the last lesson as done starts the second peak. The screen shows confetti and the course photo. It also shows how many lessons were completed. Two buttons point to what comes next. This is the moment the whole design builds towards.

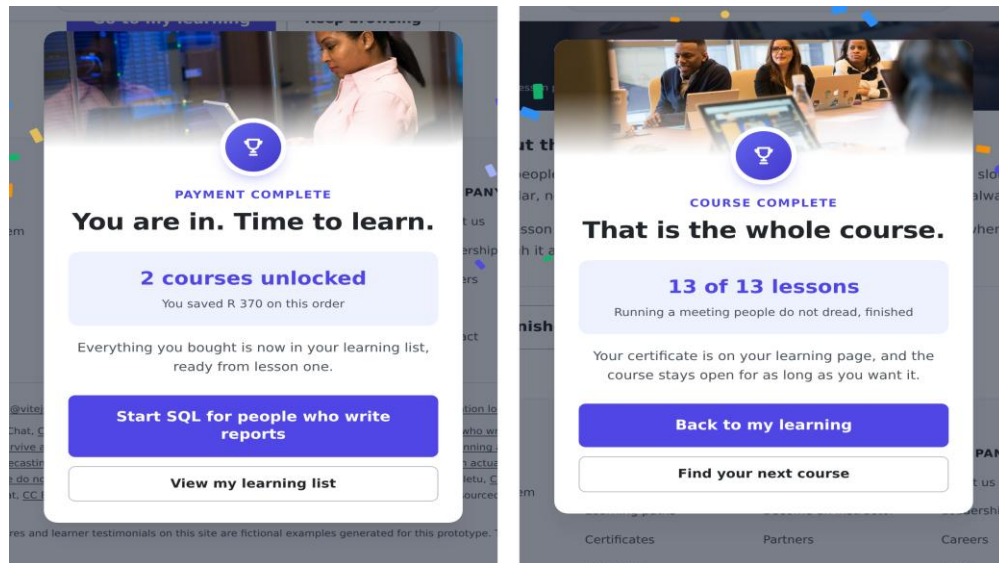


Figure 7: The two peaks: paying for a course (left) and finishing one (right)

6. Revisions to Earlier Submissions

Login page. The confirmation after signing in now has an animated tick with a ring around it. It sits one level below the peaks on the ladder.

Products page. Each course now has its own photo. Courses can go into the cart straight from the list. The whole row is still clickable. This keeps our Fitts's Law decision from Design B. A loading skeleton now shows while the catalogue loads.

Other additions. The landing page has a new photo. Returning learners also get a strip that takes them back to their course. The site now has a dark mode. Empty pages show simple drawings instead of blank space.

7. Client Requirements

Client statement	SkillUP solution
Other sites are bland	Real photos on every course and a bold landing page. Two celebrations that nothing else on the site competes with.
Checking out a course	The price sits on the pay button. A tip shows while paying. Confetti and the course photo appear when it goes through.
Pushing a button	A ripple starts where the button was pressed. Adding to the cart turns the button green with a tick.
Finishing a course	Confetti with the course photo and the lessons completed. The next step is on the same screen.
Core operations	Every operation in the brief works from start to end. Cart and progress are saved in the browser.

8. Conclusion

Design C turns the full customer journey into something learners remember. Most of the site stays quiet and easy to use. The two peaks are paying for a course and finishing one. Both end with a clear next step. Each decision came from something we saw in our research. Together they give the client a site that stands out at the moments that matter.

References

Frame by Frame (2026) UX Reports 1 to 3: Coursera, Udemy and Khan Academy. Group Design C research. University of Pretoria.

Kahneman, D., Fredrickson, B.L., Schreiber, C.A. and Redelmeier, D.A. (1993) 'When more pain is preferred to less: adding a better end', *Psychological Science*, 4(6), pp. 401-405.